IELTS ACADEMIC · WRITING TASK 2 ■ TEACHER'S EDITION

Lesson Script: the PEEL Body Paragraph

One-to-one, 60 minutes, with the handout of the same name

LEVEL Band 6.0 to 7.0 TIME 60 min FOCUS Explain move, linking to the question

RUNNING ORDER

CLOCK	MIN	STAGE	PAGE
0:00–0:05	5	1 Lead-in: what makes an answer convincing?	1
0:05–0:15	10	2 Diagnose: the weak paragraph	2
0:15–0:27	12	3 Model: the four moves	2
0:27–0:37	10	4 Controlled practice: add the Explain move	3
0:37–0:52	15	5 Freer practice: rewrite their own paragraph	3
0:52–1:00	8	6 Transfer and wrap-up	3

Total 60 min

MATERIALS

- Handout *Writing a PEEL Body Paragraph*, two copies (one to write on)
- Their last Task 2 essay (libraries question), with one body paragraph marked
- Timer; a strip of paper to cover the P/Ex/Eg/L labels on the model

■ BEFORE THE LESSON Their last essay scored about Band 6 for Task Response: ideas are relevant but listed, not developed. Today has one goal only: every point gets an Explain sentence. Do not correct grammar today unless meaning breaks down.

0:00 1 Lead-in: what makes an answer convincing? 5 min · to 0:05

Aim: Activate the idea that claims need reasons, before any writing.

SAY Before we look at essays, a quick question. Your friend says, "You should move to Melbourne." What would they need to say next for you to actually believe them?

EXPECT
- *Why: the weather, jobs, it's cheaper...*
- *Give me an example, like a friend who moved there.*

PROBE
→ So a reason on its own isn't enough. What does the example add?
→ Which would persuade you more: three reasons, or one reason explained properly?

IF **If they answer in one word** → Model it yourself in two sentences (claim, then *because*), then ask them to do the same about their own city.

0:05 2 Diagnose: the weak paragraph

10 min · to 0:15

Aim: They find the missing moves themselves.

DO
- Hand out the handout. Cover the model with the paper strip; only the weak paragraph is visible.
- Give them two minutes, silently.

SAY Read the second paragraph, the one on the right. Imagine you are the examiner. / pause / Which sentence actually answers the question about advantages and disadvantages?

EXPECT
- *None of them really.*
- *The last one? "Libraries should not be replaced..."*

PROBE
- → Does the example about the friend prove anything about cities?
- → If you deleted the first two sentences, what would the paragraph lose?

IF **If they defend the weak paragraph** → Agree that the opinion is clear, then ask: *why* should libraries stay? Write their answer down word for word. That sentence becomes their Explain move in stage 4.

0:15 3 Model: the four moves

12 min · to 0:27

Aim: Name P, Ex, Eg and L, and see them in a Band 7 paragraph.

BOARD

P	Point	one claim that answers the question
Ex	Explain	why or how it is true
Eg	Example	one specific case
L	Link	back to the question's own words

SAY Now uncover the model on the left. Each sentence has a job. Before you look at my labels, tell me: which sentence is doing the explaining?

EXPECT
- *The second one, about crowded homes.*

PROBE
- → What would happen to the example about the teenager if we removed that sentence?
- → Find the words in the last sentence that come from the question.

DO
- Read the key point box together. Point out that Explain is the move their essay was missing.

0:27 4 Controlled practice: add the Explain move

10 min · to 0:37

Aim: Write one Explain sentence for three given points.

SAY I'll give you a point. You give me only the Explain sentence. Use one of the chunks from the table: *this is largely because* or *which means that*.

DO
- Points, one at a time: (1) Online services save public money. (2) Libraries support people without home internet. (3) Digital archives last longer than paper.
- Accept the sentence orally first, then they write it.

EXPECT
- This is largely because *a single website can serve a whole city, which means that councils do not need to pay for buildings and staff.*

IF **If they repeat the point in new words** → Ask "Why is that true?" and wait. Their spoken answer is the Explain sentence; have them write exactly what they said.

0:37 5 Freer practice: rewrite their own paragraph

15 min · to 0:52

Aim: Apply PEEL to the marked paragraph from last week's essay.

DO
- Give back their essay. Timer: 12 minutes.
- While they write, do not interrupt. Note one strong sentence to praise.

SAY Rewrite this paragraph using all four moves. Keep your original idea; just make the examiner see your reasoning.

PROBE
→ Read me only your Explain sentence. Does it say why, or does it add another fact?
→ Underline the words in your last sentence that come from the question.

IF **If they finish early** → Ask for a second Example that argues the other side, then a Link that weighs the two.

0:52 6 Transfer and wrap-up

8 min · to 1:00

Aim: Show that the same structure works in a spoken long turn.

SPEAKING PART 2

Describe a public place in your town that you think is important.

You should say:
- where it is
- who uses it
- what people do there

and explain why you think it is important.

One minute to prepare, then speak for up to two minutes.

SAY Same idea, but spoken. Give me a point, explain it, give one real example, and finish by saying why it matters. One minute to think.

DO
- Close with the self-check list on the handout. They tick only what is true of today's paragraph.
- Homework: one full Task 2 essay; every body paragraph must have an Explain sentence.